



TOWN OF BROOKLINE
Massachusetts
DEPARTMENT OF PUBLIC WORKS
Engineering & Transportation Division

Erin Chute
Commissioner
Robert King, P.E.
Director

Transportation Board Meeting Minutes
July 19, 2023 6:30pm via Zoom Remote Meeting
Recording: <https://www.brooklinema.gov/2191/Meetings-Recordings>

Transportation Board Members Present: Brian Kane (Chair), Jonathan Kapust, P.E. (Vice Chair), Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore.

Town Staff Present: Robert King, P.E. (Director of Engineering & Transportation), Amy Ingles (Transportation Administrator), Daniel Martin (Sustainable Transportation Engineer), Sam Downes (Transportation Engineer), Todd Cantor (Brookline Fire Department), Mike Murphy (Brookline Police Department).

Meeting called to order by Brian Kane.

Item 2: Public Comment:

Public comment was provided by David Trevvett sharing that cars continue to be prioritized over pedestrians. We are still confusing pedestrians with the Town's signage.

Item 3: Member Update

There were no member updates.

Item 4: DPW Update

Provided by Robert King:

- The packet provided to Board members highlights the ongoing projects in our Department.
- Select Board approved Chapter 90 funding for the 5 streets that will be worked on as part of our combined Chapter 90 and Complete Streets efforts. Kickoff for that work is upcoming.
- Work continues on roads in and through Larz Anderson Park.

Item 5: Discussion And Action On The Complete Streets Prioritization Plan List Of Projects For Submittal To Massachusetts Department Of Transportation Complete Streets Funding Program

Presentation by Toole Design. There were no public comments. Discussion between Board members and presentation team/Transportation Division staff only.

A motion was made to Shonali Gaudino to approve the Complete Streets Funding Program Project Prioritization Plan as presented.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore, Jonathan Kapust.

Item 6: Discussion And Action On A Vote Of Support For The Design Review Committee's Endorsement Davis Path Foot Footbridge Concept Plan

Presentation by William Smith (Department of Public Works), UIL, and WSP. There were no public comments. Discussion between Board members and presentation/Transportation Division staff.

A motion was made to Shonali Gaudino to support the Davis Avenue Foot bridge design review committee's Davis path foot footbridge concept plan.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore, Jonathan Kapust.

Item 7: Annual Funding Request From The Brookline Council On Aging For The TRIPPS Program

Presentation by Ruthann Dobek and Maria Foster. No action taken. Discussion only.

Public comment by Yolanda Rodriguez in support of how important this program is for the seniors in Town.

Item 8: Discussion And Action On The Proposed Budget Recommendation For The Towns Transportation Network Company Assessment Fees To The November Special Town Meeting

A motion was made by Len Wholey to approve of the staff proposed projects to be included in the November 2023 Special Town Meeting Warrant budget amendment to be funded with the CY2022 (FY2024) TNC funds. The COA's ask was to full fund the TRIPPS program with the remaining funding going to the bench program.

Commented [AI1]: I think it would be good to mention what the projects were. Doesn't have to be in great detail. Just basically saying that the COA's ask was fully funded with the remaining going to the bench program.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore, Jonathan Kapust.

Item 9: Discussion And Action On Revised Bicycle Improvements Surrounding The Brookline High School Campus

Presentation by Rob King and Amy Ingles. Discussion between Transportation Board members and Town Staff.

Public comment was shared by Mitch Heineman highlighting need to retain bike facilities.

Public comment was shared by David Trevvett stated need to have this be a pilot.

Public comment was shared by Deborah Rivers against the proposed modifications surround BHS.

Public comment was shared by David Lapidus against the proposed modifications surround BHS.

Public comment was shared by Gideon (last name unknown) resident of Davis Avenue shared support for a parking-protected contraflow bike lane on Davis Avenue

Public comment was shared by Scott Englander against the proposed modifications surround BHS.

Public comment was shared by Nathan Freitas spoke on behalf of contraflow lane on Davis Avenue.

Concerns with difficulties of Tappan Street design.

Public comment was shared by John Bowman against the proposed modifications surround BHS.

Believes bicyclists will bike contraflow on Tappan regardless if a bike lane is installed.

Public comment was shared by David Kroop against the proposed modifications surround BHS. Shared concerns over process and number of protected bike facilities.

Public comment was shared by Bill Heinemann asking about moving northern curb and potential to have raised bike lane.

Public comment was shared by Anthony Ishak about his concerns of safety around BHS, need to slow traffic, worry over vulnerable use, and environmental concerns.

Public comment was shared by Bob Miller against the proposed modifications surround BHS and should not be in response to a crisis. Need to address all users. Support for contraflow on Davis Avenue.

Public comment was shared by Willem, recent BHS graduate, stating they will take the shortest route to school regardless of bike facilities.

Public comment was shared by Marina Arcaya against the proposed modifications surround BHS.

A motion was made by Jonathan Kapust to accept the staff recommendation to approve the cross sections as presented for Cypress, Tappan, Greenough, and Davis with a requirement to come back to the Transportation Board before the end of the 2023-2024 school year.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Jonathan Kapust, Nancy Moore.

Nay: Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey.

Item 10: Discussion And Action On The Annual Relicensing

A motion was made by Shonali Gaudino to accept DPW Transportation staff's recommendation that a Valet License be issued to Golden Temple Restaurant authorizing the use of four (4) metered parking spaces in front of their establishment located at 1651 Beacon Street from 5 PM to 12 AM daily and ten (10) spaces along the Beacon Street Inbound Median between the hours of 6 PM and 12 AM for a period of one (1) year ending June 30, 2024.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore, Jonathan Kapust.

A motion was made by Brian Kane to accept DPW Transportation staff's recommendation to issue a Valet License to Longwood Towers Condominium Trust for the period ending June 30, 2024.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore, Jonathan Kapust.

A motion was made by Brian Kane to accept DPW Transportation staff's recommendation to issue a Valet License to Hilton Garden Inn for the period ending June 30, 2024.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore, Jonathan Kapust.

A motion was made by Brian Kane to renew the Jitney License to Tribal Sub Bus Company, LLC (dba FLiXBUS) with the conditions outlined by Transportation Division staff's memorandum ending October 30th, 2023 with the provision that Tribal Sub Bus Company, LLC (dba FLiXBUS) is required to come before the Transportation Board in September or October of 2023.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore, Jonathan Kapust.

Item 11: Other Business

No other business.

A motion was made by Shonali Gaudino to approve the June 2023 meeting minutes.

Aye: Brian Kane, Shonali Gaudino, Wendy Friedman, Len Wholey, Nancy Moore.

Present: Jonathan Kapust.

The Chair ended the meeting at 10:30pm.

For additional detail associated with public comment and the meeting items discussed, please see a copy of the July 19, 2023 meeting's audio recording and transcript here:

<https://www.brooklinema.gov/2191/Meetings-Recordings>

The meeting's agenda, board packet, and a copy of the meeting minutes are available here:

<https://www.brooklinema.gov/392/Transportation-Board>